

Becky Sherman

Design Executive | AI Strategy, Product Design and UX Research

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SUMMARY

Design executive leading a 130+ person UX organization at American Airlines through its shift to AI-assisted design. Expanded the organization beyond product design, research and design systems by taking on content design, accessibility and AI. Founded its design operations and design thinking practices to build stronger teams that deliver. Leads its AI strategy, with pilots cutting design-to-code hours 20% to 40%. Results span retail, telecom, industrial software and aviation, including a \$111 million revenue lift on a \$24.3 billion booking engine.

EXPERIENCE

Director of User Experience

2018 to present

American Airlines | Dallas

Owns 140+ customer and employee applications, from web, mobile and kiosk to crew and operations tools.

AI leadership

- Leads the UX organization's AI strategy, built with Design Ops and AI engineering. Secured VP sponsorship and funding for new AI roles, with a second round of headcount in progress. Now defining governance for AI use across design.
- Cut design-to-code hours per screen 20% to 40% in pilots using Figma Make and GitHub Copilot. Now leading the team in re-engineering how product designers and engineers work together, with little to no handoff and AI tools connected to our design system through MCP servers.
- Built the research operations, design system and leadership bench that let teams deliver AI products without day-to-day oversight, including Tailored Offers personalization and Retell AI voice agents for AAdvantage Business sales.
- Enabled the team behind HEAT (Hub Efficiency Analytics Tool), an in-house decision tool, since enhanced with AI, that reshapes hub schedules ahead of severe weather. It cut cancellations 80% versus similar storms, has prevented about 1,000 and won an Aviation Week Laureate Award in 2024.

Product and business results

- Built Aileron, a design system now reaching 66% of the customer-facing development community.
- Framed the booking engine business problem with the executive steering committee and oversaw the discovery research behind the redesign. The team carried it through design and delivery, adding \$111 million in incremental revenue with a 3.6% increase in revenue per visit.
- Enabled the team that redesigned the app for iOS 26 with Apple, beating the revenue forecast by \$2.3 million and earning featured App Store placement.
- Put the research and design support in place for the COVID-era self-service transformation across web, mobile and kiosk for 200+ million annual customers, lifting usage 10% and conversion 7.5%.
- Supported a new Integrated Operations Center communication system that cut call volume 46%.

Research leadership

- Moved research from a specialist service to a scaled practice, enabling 100+ product designers to run studies alongside nine dedicated researchers. Delivered 500+ studies in three years, including airport observation plus research with pilots, flight attendants and mechanics.
- Built research operations, including an onsite UX lab and end-to-end tooling procurement. Won UserTesting Illumi Awards in 2024 and 2026 for the QX score program.

Organization building

- Scaled the UX organization from 40 to 130+ people, growing leadership roles from five to 15. Led the team through a 30% COVID reduction and rebuild while protecting delivery.
- Founded Design Ops and Design Thinking at American, scaling human-centered practice to 200+ teams.
- Built career paths, then persuaded executive leadership and finance to move the UX organization onto a higher pay scale, strengthening hiring and retention.

User Experience Manager

2014 to 2018

Siemens PLM

- Built the UX function from five software developers into a 27-person team across the U.S., Europe and Asia in 2.5 years, earning promotion from team lead to manager within a year.
- Partnered with the director who is now president of the PLM organization to make UX part of the product lifecycle, a model still in use. Created the first design system for the PLM product suite.
- Established the first UX lab in Pune, India, and trained 27 product designers to run usability testing on every release. Presented at PLM Connections in 2016 and 2017.

Director of User Experience

2013 to 2014

Reachlocal

- Promoted from team lead to director within six months. Centralized UX for web, mobile and CRM platforms, then implemented half of 100+ audit recommendations in three months.
- Trained designers with no research background to run their own studies using repeatable testing frameworks.

Director of eBusiness

2010 to 2013

MetroPCS

- Rebuilt the web and mobile eCommerce platforms in under 18 months, managing a \$4 million budget with customer research setting roadmap priorities. Promoted from IT delivery manager to director in two years.

Product Manager, Skunkworks Innovation Team

2007 to 2010

Superpages.com (Idearc, a Verizon spin-off)

- Owned a search platform generating \$55 million in annual revenue. Joined the Skunkworks innovation team to launch a mobile marketplace connecting homeowners with home improvement pros, generating \$20 million a year.

Usability Manager

2007

Blockbuster

- Built a UX research lab running weekly customer sessions. A subscription pricing study from the lab lifted subscriptions 7% in its first month.

User Experience Manager and Search Product Manager

2000 to 2007

JCPenney

- Owned the search platform behind \$100 million+ in annual revenue while leading UX. Hired the company's first UX researcher and built a three-person research team.

Earlier experience: Creative Director, Breakaway Solutions | Internet Experience Manager, ACS | eCommerce Specialist, CSC | Brand Manager, Electronic Data Systems

LEADERSHIP AND RECOGNITION

- Founding member, Design Executive Council, 2026
- Partner to the founder of Dallas Black UX on talent pipeline and peer mentorship, 2023 to 2025
- Customer Advisory Board, UserTesting, 2019 to 2022
- Eli Leadership Lab, women's leadership program, 2022
- Featured in "Usability Success Stories," Gower, 2006

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

University of Texas at Dallas, Master of Science, Applied Cognition and Neuroscience, specialization in Human-Computer Interaction

Southern Methodist University, Bachelor of Science, Political Science, and Bachelor of Arts, Public Relations
Certified Design Thinking Leader, IBM. Certified Design Thinking Practitioner, LUMA Institute.